

Business Reports & Essays

Question Booklet

20-mark questions only: four business reports and eight essays (two per topic), from past HSC and trial papers in your Drive.

SECTION	QUESTIONS			
Part 1 — Business reports	Q1–4	4 questions	80 marks	p. 2
Part 2 — Essays	Q5–12	8 questions	160 marks	p. 7

How to use this booklet

1. Each question is on its own page with a planning box. Plan for 5 minutes, then write for 30 on separate paper.
2. **Business reports** need report format: title, to/from, introduction, headings for each dot point in the question, recommendations and conclusion.
3. **Essays** need an introduction with a clear thesis, 3–4 body paragraphs (theory → link → case study evidence) and a conclusion that answers the question.
4. The answer booklet has the official marking guidelines for each question plus a model response written in the structure from your notes (using Qantas as the case study) – except where the official guidelines already include a full exemplar response.

Part 1 — Business reports

Each report integrates two or more topics, like the HSC Section III question.

Q1 2022 HSC · Question 25

20 marks

Bee Sticky Pty Ltd is an established Australian manufacturing business that produces a wide range of high quality and premium organic honey. It is expanding into global markets. It will lease warehouses in Malaysia and the USA.

The company has provided you with a recently completed SWOT analysis.

SWOT analysis	
<i>Strengths</i> • High quality, premium and organic honey products • Approved for consumption and medical uses • Made by honeybees from Australian flora	<i>Weaknesses</i> • Frequent breakage of product during transportation • Lack of experience in foreign payment systems
<i>Opportunities</i> • Expanding market for high quality honey in countries overseas • Falling bee populations overseas • Potential collaborations with up-market restaurants/chefs	<i>Threats</i> • Established competition in foreign markets • Fluctuations in the Australian dollar

You have been hired as a consultant by Bee Sticky Pty Ltd to write a business report for the owners. In your report:

- describe branding and product strategies the business could use to expand into global markets
- recommend a channel choice that would suit this business's expansion
- analyse the global financial management strategies required for a successful expansion.

PLAN**Thesis / judgement****Body 1****Body 2****Body 3****Case study evidence****Conclusion**

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Future Century Gaming Pty Ltd operates an online gaming platform targeting players aged 18–40 in Australia. It has been in operation since 2012, providing subscription access to a variety of online games.

The business is considering expanding into emerging global markets but is finding it challenging to recruit and retain skilled, qualified game designers and developers in Australia. It is considering international labour markets to overcome staff shortages.

The business has decided to finance its expansion into global markets through external sources.

The directors have asked you to write a business report in which you:

- outline some of the challenges including the global factors of costs, skills and supply the business may need to consider in recruiting and retaining staff
- compare the use of debt and equity as sources of finance
- recommend ONE source of finance this business could use to fund its expansion.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Fly Well Airlines Ltd is a low-cost Australian based domestic airline that has been exploring options to expand globally. Its domestic customers in Australia typically tend to be business executives and budget conscious leisure travellers.

The business intends to begin operating flights into the highly competitive Asian market in the latter part of 2023. To achieve this, the business will have to fund the purchase of new computerised ticketing and baggage facilities at its Sydney terminal. Management believes there is also opportunity for the airline to move all scheduled aircraft servicing and maintenance to a contractor in Singapore. Employees who belong to unions have indicated they will respond to this with industrial action. Management is also concerned about the best way to achieve a sustainable competitive advantage in their new overseas markets.

You have been hired as a consultant to write a report for Fly Well Airlines Ltd.

In your report:

- Outline ONE advantage and ONE disadvantage of outsourcing aircraft servicing and maintenance.
- Discuss issues involved in raising funds through both debt and equity finance and make a recommendation to management about which source of funding to use.
- Explain TWO human resource strategies that could assist Fly Well Airlines Ltd to address management concerns and help achieve business success.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Zilor is a bicycle and scooter manufacturer and retailer. It makes high quality products in Australia. Zilor has built its reputation on innovation and has been operating for 20 years.

Despite its past performance, Zilor faces several challenges:

- falling retail sales the past two years and rising input costs
- current marketing efforts have been limited to radio and print media
- wholesale competitors are selling cheap imported electric bicycles and scooters

For the first time ever, Zilor is planning to import parts from overseas in order to manufacture and retail electric bicycles and scooters to increase its market share and sales.

You have been hired as a consultant by Zilor to write a business report to the owners. In your report:

- Outline how the business could adopt e-marketing and differentiation strategies as part of its marketing plan to improve sales.
- Analyse the operations processes required to be implemented by the business to address its goals.
- Recommend TWO operations strategies that can help the business to sustain its competitive advantage.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Part 2 — Essays

Two essays per topic: Operations, Marketing, Finance, Human Resources.

Q5

2022 HSC · Question 27

20 marks

Explain the importance to a business of having operations processes that can maintain a competitive advantage.

PLAN
Thesis / judgement
Body 1
Body 2
Body 3
Case study evidence
Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

To what extent do influences on operations affect business success?

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

To what extent do influences on marketing affect business success?

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Analyse how a situational analysis (SWOT, product life cycle) may affect marketing strategies.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Assess the significance of financial management strategies in ensuring the long-term objectives of a business are achieved.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Analyse how different sources of finance impact the financial objectives of a business.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Explain the importance to a business of having human resources strategies that reduce workplace disputes and increase worker satisfaction.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.

Analyse how human resource management strategies can improve the process of employee acquisition and maintenance.

PLAN

Thesis / judgement

Body 1

Body 2

Body 3

Case study evidence

Conclusion

Write your full response on separate paper — about 35 minutes / 4 pages.